CDL Passenger Endorsement Questions and Answers

30 practice questions with answers and explanations, grouped by topic

Written from the Commercial Driver's License Manual (Version 07/20/2026 (form DMV 60A), AAMVA, Virginia DMV edition). Each answer names the manual section it comes from.

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How to use this PDF: answer the questions in Part 1 first, then check yourself with the answer key in Part 2.

Passing score on each CDL knowledge test: at least 80% correct (49 CFR 383.135).

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Part 1: Questions

Vehicle inspection (7 questions)

1. **During your check of the outside of the bus, what should you do with an open baggage or engine access panel?**
   - **A.** Close it before driving
   - **B.** Leave it open until the first stop
   - **C.** Lock it in a partly open position
   - **D.** Note it on the report and drive on

2. **If your bus has a red emergency door light, when should it be turned on?**
   - **A.** Only when a rider opens the emergency door
   - **B.** At night or whenever you use your outside lights
   - **C.** Only while the bus is stopped to load riders
   - **D.** Only when the bus has broken down on the road

3. **What type of tires are not allowed on the front wheels of a bus?**
   - **A.** Tires with a deep mud and snow tread
   - **B.** Tubeless tires with steel belts
   - **C.** Tires with a higher load rating
   - **D.** Recapped or re-grooved tires

4. **What should you keep in mind while driving with emergency roof hatches partly open?**
   - **A.** The bus's longer stopping distance
   - **B.** The bus's wider turning path
   - **C.** The bus's higher clearance
   - **D.** The bus's lower fuel mileage

5. **When should you sign the previous driver's inspection report for your bus?**
   - **A.** As soon as you have read it, before checking any defects
   - **B.** Only if earlier defects were certified repaired or not needing repair
   - **C.** After you have driven the bus for its first trip of the day
   - **D.** Whenever the previous driver listed no more than two defects

6. **Why should you always check the interior of your bus before driving?**
   - **A.** Riders must watch the driver complete the check
   - **B.** It takes the place of the outside inspection
   - **C.** The seats must be rearranged for every trip
   - **D.** People sometimes damage buses left unattended

7. **If a bus uses fuses rather than reflective triangles as its emergency reflectors, at least how many fuses must it carry?**
   - **A.** 3 fuses
   - **B.** 4 fuses
   - **C.** 6 fuses
   - **D.** 8 fuses

Loading and trip start (8 questions)

8. **Where must riders not be allowed to leave their carry-on baggage?**
   - **A.** In a doorway or aisle
   - **B.** Under their own seats
   - **C.** On the overhead racks
   - **D.** In the baggage bay below

9. **Why should charter bus drivers keep riders off the bus until departure time?**
   - **A.** To keep the fuel tank from running low
   - **B.** To give riders time to buy their tickets
   - **C.** To help prevent theft or vandalism of the bus
   - **D.** To keep the standee line clear for loading

10. **How many different diamond-shaped hazard labels are there?**
    - **A.** Four
    - **B.** Six
    - **C.** Eight
    - **D.** Nine

11. **Shippers must mark containers of hazardous material with the material's name, its identification number and:**
    - **A.** The shipper's phone number
    - **B.** The weight of the contents
    - **C.** The hazard label
    - **D.** The date it was packed

12. What is the most total weight of allowed hazardous materials a bus may carry?

- **A.** 250 pounds
- **B.** 500 pounds
- **C.** 750 pounds
- **D.** 1,000 pounds

13. When may a bus carry small amounts of some other hazardous materials?

- **A.** When riders sign a written waiver
- **B.** When the shipper cannot send them any other way
- **C.** When the bus is less than half full
- **D.** When the trip is shorter than 50 miles

14. No rider may stand forward of:

- **A.** The rear of the driver's seat
- **B.** The front edge of the stairwell
- **C.** The first row of rider seats
- **D.** The center of the front door

15. If the aisle is lower than the seats, when is it best to remind riders about the step-down?

- **A.** After the front door has been opened
- **B.** Only when a rider asks for help
- **C.** At the start of the trip only
- **D.** Before the bus comes to a complete stop

On the road (9 questions)

16. If your bus leans toward the outside on a banked curve, what does that mean?

- **A.** The tires need more air pressure
- **B.** The load has shifted to one side
- **C.** You are driving too fast
- **D.** The curve is banked the wrong way

17. When you must stop at a drawbridge, at least how far before the draw should you stop?

- **A.** 15 feet
- **B.** 25 feet
- **C.** 50 feet
- **D.** 100 feet

18. Where do bus accidents often happen?

- **A.** On long, straight highways
- **B.** In bus parking garages
- **C.** On divided four-lane roads
- **D.** At intersections

19. When pulling out from a bus stop into traffic, what should you do?

- **A.** Wait until a gap big enough for the bus opens
- **B.** Signal and expect other drivers to brake for you
- **C.** Ease out slowly so traffic will make room
- **D.** Sound the horn to warn drivers you are coming

20. At which railroad crossing do you not have to stop, though you must still slow down and check for other vehicles?

- **A.** One on a rural road without gates
- **B.** One where the tracks look clear
- **C.** One where the crossing lights are off
- **D.** One where a flagman is directing traffic

21. When stopped at a railroad crossing, when should you open your forward door?

- **A.** Only when the crossing has no gates or lights
- **B.** If it helps you see or hear an approaching train
- **C.** Only after the front wheels reach the first rail
- **D.** Only when a flagman tells you to proceed

22. If your bus has a manual transmission, what must you never do while crossing railroad tracks?

- **A.** Change gears
- **B.** Sound the horn
- **C.** Check your mirrors
- **D.** Use the turn signal

23. When should you mention the carrier's rules about smoking, drinking or playing radios?

- **A.** At the start of the trip
- **B.** Only after a rider breaks a rule
- **C.** At the first rest stop
- **D.** When riders leave at the destination

24. After riders get on at a stop, what should you wait for before starting the bus?

- **A.** For riders to put every carry-on in the overhead rack
- **B.** For riders to sit down or brace themselves
- **C.** For riders to show their tickets a second time
- **D.** For the interior aisle lights to switch off

After-trip vehicle inspection (2 questions)

25. If you drive for an interstate carrier, what must you complete for each bus you drove?

- **A.** A written inspection report
- **B.** A rider head count form
- **C.** A fuel purchase record
- **D.** A route timing sheet

26. Why should you report rider damage to parts such as seats and handholds at the end of your shift?

- **A.** So the riders can be charged for the damage
- **B.** So mechanics can repair it before the bus goes out again
- **C.** So the bus can be kept off its route for a week
- **D.** So the next driver can decide whether to fix it

Prohibited practices (2 questions)

27. Where must you never refuel a bus with riders on board?

- **A.** At an outdoor truck stop
- **B.** At a self-service fuel island
- **C.** At the carrier's own fuel pump
- **D.** In a closed building

28. When may you tow or push a disabled bus while riders are still aboard?

- **A.** Whenever the tow is less than one mile
- **B.** When all riders agree to stay on board
- **C.** Only when getting off would be unsafe for them
- **D.** When your employer cannot send another bus

Brake-door interlocks (2 questions)

29. On an urban mass transit coach, what does the brake and accelerator interlock do when the rear door is open?

- **A.** Applies the brakes and holds the throttle at idle
- **B.** Sounds a buzzer and flashes the brake lights
- **C.** Shuts off the engine and turns on hazard lights
- **D.** Locks the front door and releases the brakes

30. What releases the brake and accelerator interlock on a transit coach?

- **A.** Pressing the accelerator pedal down hard
- **B.** Closing the rear door
- **C.** Turning the ignition off and back on
- **D.** Opening the front door

Part 2: Answer key

Each answer has a short explanation in our own words and the CDL manual section it comes from. Reread that section for every question you missed.

Vehicle inspection

1. **A. Close it before driving**
   Access panels such as those for baggage, restroom service and the engine must be shut before you drive away, just like any open emergency exits.
   Manual section 4.1.2 Access Doors and Panels

2. **B. At night or whenever you use your outside lights**
   The red emergency door light must work, and it should be on in the dark and at any other time your outside lights are on.
   Manual section 4.1.3 Bus Interior

3. **D. Recapped or re-grooved tires**
   Part of the tire check before driving is making sure neither front wheel has a tire that was recapped or re-grooved.
   Manual section 4.1.1 Vehicle Systems

4. **C. The bus's higher clearance**
   With roof hatches open the bus needs more overhead room than usual, so watch for low clearances until they are closed.
   Manual section 4.1.4 Roof Hatches

5. **B. Only if earlier defects were certified repaired or not needing repair**
   Your signature certifies that the problems found earlier were dealt with, so sign only after they are certified as repaired or as not needing repair.
   Manual section 4.1 Vehicle Inspection

6. **D. People sometimes damage buses left unattended**
   A bus that sat unattended may have been damaged by someone, so an inside check before each trip helps keep your riders safe.
   Manual section 4.1.3 Bus Interior

7. **C. 6 fuses**
   The law calls for three reflective triangles, three liquid burning flares, or a minimum of six fuses as the bus's emergency reflectors.
   Manual section 4.1.1 Vehicle Systems

Loading and trip start

8. **A. In a doorway or aisle**
   Bags left in a doorway or aisle can trip other riders, so those spaces must stay clear of carry-ons.
   Manual section 4.2 Loading and Trip Start

9. **C. To help prevent theft or vandalism of the bus**
   Keeping a charter bus closed to riders until it is time to leave helps protect the bus from theft and damage.
   Manual section 4.2.4 At Your Destination

10. **D. Nine**
    There are nine hazard labels in all, each a four-inch diamond, which is why you should watch for that shape on cargo and baggage.
    Manual section 4.2.1 Hazardous Materials

11. **C. The hazard label**
    Each container of hazardous material must carry three markings from the shipper: the material's name, its ID number and its hazard label.
    Manual section 4.2.1 Hazardous Materials

12. **B. 500 pounds**
    A bus must never carry over 500 pounds of allowed hazardous materials in all, and no more than 100 pounds of any one class.
    Manual section 4.2.2 Forbidden Hazardous Materials

13. **B. When the shipper cannot send them any other way**
    Beyond the items buses may always carry, small amounts of some other hazardous materials are allowed only when the shipper has no other way to ship them.
    Manual section 4.2.2 Forbidden Hazardous Materials

14. **A. The rear of the driver's seat**
    Standing riders must stay behind the back of the driver's seat, and buses that allow standing mark this limit on the floor.
    Manual section 4.2.3 Standee Line

15. **D. Before the bus comes to a complete stop**
    Give the step-down reminder while the bus is still moving toward the stop, not after it has already stopped.
    Manual section 4.2.4 At Your Destination

On the road

16. **C. You are driving too fast**
    A bus leaning outward on a banked curve is a sign of too much speed, so slow down for the curve.
    Manual section 4.3.4 Speed on Curves

17. **C. 50 feet**
    Where a stop is required at a drawbridge, keep a gap of no less than 50 feet between your bus and the draw.
    Manual section 4.3.6 Drawbridges

18. **D. At intersections**
    Intersections are a common place for bus crashes, so stay careful there even when signals or stop signs control the other traffic.
    Manual section 4.3.3 Common Accidents

19. **A. Wait until a gap big enough for the bus opens**
    Know how much space the bus needs to speed up and merge, and do not leave the stop until that space is there.
    Manual section 4.3.3 Common Accidents

20. **D. One where a flagman is directing traffic**
    A stop is not required where a police officer or flagman is directing traffic, but you must still slow down and look carefully for other vehicles.
    Manual section 4.3.5 Railroad-highway Crossing/ Stops

21. **B. If it helps you see or hear an approaching train**
    Opening the front door can make it easier to hear or spot a train that is coming, so do it whenever it improves your check.
    Manual section 4.3.5 Railroad-highway Crossing/ Stops

22. **A. Change gears**
    Shifting while on the tracks is not allowed with a manual transmission; stay in the same gear until you are across.
    Manual section 4.3.5 Railroad-highway Crossing/ Stops

23. **A. At the start of the trip**

Explaining the comfort and safety rules as the trip begins helps you avoid trouble with riders later on.

Manual section 4.3.1 Passenger Supervision

24. **B. For riders to sit down or brace themselves**

Riders can stumble when the bus moves off, so give them time to be seated or holding on before you start.

Manual section 4.3.2 At Stops

After-trip vehicle inspection

25. **A. A written inspection report**

Drivers for an interstate carrier must write up an inspection report for every bus they drove, listing any defect that affects safety or could cause a breakdown.

Manual section 4.4 After-trip Vehicle Inspection

26. **B. So mechanics can repair it before the bus goes out again**

Reporting damage when your shift ends gives mechanics time to fix safety-related parts before the bus is used for another trip.

Manual section 4.4 After-trip Vehicle Inspection

Prohibited practices

27. **D. In a closed building**

Fueling with riders aboard should be avoided unless truly needed, and it is never allowed inside a closed building.

Manual section 4.5 Prohibited Practices

28. **C. Only when getting off would be unsafe for them**

Riders should leave a disabled bus before it is towed or pushed, unless leaving the bus would put them in danger.

Manual section 4.5 Prohibited Practices

Brake-door interlocks

29. **A. Applies the brakes and holds the throttle at idle**

While the rear door is open, the interlock keeps the brakes on and the throttle at idle so the coach cannot move off.

Manual section 4.6 Use of Brake-door Interlocks

30. **B. Closing the rear door**

Once the rear door is shut, the interlock lets go of the brakes and the throttle.

Manual section 4.6 Use of Brake-door Interlocks

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